CONTINENTAL RAILS



Lay the line that joins a nation.

America, 1869. Two great railroads are racing to meet somewhere in the West. From the Pacific coast, crews blast tunnels through granite; from the prairie, gangs throw bridges over rivers that have never seen iron. You run one of the companies bidding for the routes in between. Send your workers out for Iron, Wood, Gunpowder and money, let your specialists turn them into track, and lay it across the map one whole route at a time. Raise stations, string the telegraph, lobby Congress, and be the one who joins coast to coast.

2–4 players · **60–90 minutes** · **Age 15+**

GAME DESIGN: **DEAN MORRIS**

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WELCOME *the game at a glance*

1 COLLECT



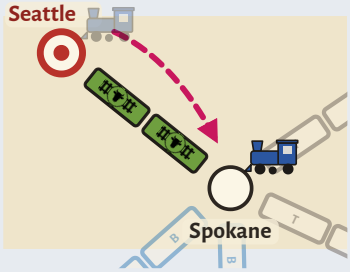
A worker on the grid gathers Iron.

2 BUILD



*Your board turns 2 Iron into 1 built **Ground** tile.*

3 LAY



*2 built **Ground** tiles lay Seattle-Spokane.*

Continental Rails is a game of building the transcontinental railroad. Over the game you will do three things again and again:

1 **Collect.** Place or remove one of your workers on the shared **action grid** to gather Iron, Wood, Gunpowder or Coins.

2 **Build.** Run your **player board**: your Foreman and your specialists turn resources into **built track tiles**, which wait in your storage. This is called a **board activation**.

3 **Lay.** Take the **Lay Tracks** action to spend built tiles from your storage and **lay a whole route** on the map, scoring it as you lay it. One of your two **trains** rides along it to the city at the other end, where you may raise a building.

How you score. You score victory points (VP) as you play: for every slot of track you lay, for being first to connect a city, for each telegraph station you raise, when a rival's train enters a city that holds one of your railway stations, from Congress, and from some carriage upgrades. Laid track belongs to nobody: you score it when you lay it, and only your buildings stay yours. The player who lays the route that completes the first line of track from a west start city to an east start city takes a large bonus. At the end you score for your buildings on the map and for the three goal cards.

HISTORY: THE RACE OF 1869

In 1863 the Central Pacific *began building east from Sacramento, and in 1865 the* Union Pacific *began laying track west from Omaha. For every mile it laid, each company was granted public land and lent government bonds, more for mountains than for plains, so the two raced each other across the continent: Chinese crews of the Central Pacific blasted through the granite of the* Sierra Nevada, *while largely Irish gangs of the Union Pacific laid rail across the plains. The lines met at* Promontory Summit, *Utah Territory, on 10 May 1869.*

CONCEPT BUILD IS NOT LAY

These are two different actions. No single action both builds and lays.

- **Building** happens on your player board. It turns resources into track tiles and never touches the map.
- **Laying** happens on the map. It spends tiles you have already built and never makes a tile.

A track tile always moves the same way: **general supply → your storage (built) → a route on the map (laid)**. If a tile is not in your storage, you cannot lay it.

CONCEPT WORDS WITH ONE MEANING

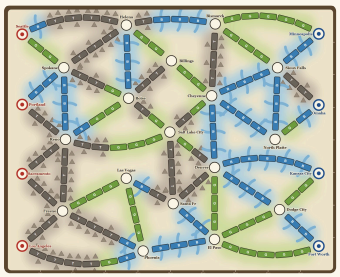
- **Train**: one of your two pieces on the map. Nothing else is a train.
- **Player board**: your own board, with its engine, house tracks, storage and telegraph pole, plus the **carriages** you add to it.
- **House**: a piece on your player board that holds production down. A house that goes onto the map becomes a **railway station** and is never called a house again.
- **District**: one of the nine areas of the action grid. **City**: a circle on the map.
- **Iron, Wood, Gunpowder** are resources. **Coins** are money, not a resource.
- **Ground**, **Tunnel**, **Bridge** are the three kinds of track tile.

How it ends. The game ends when the first line of track crosses the map, or when enough routes have been laid. Play on until the player on the start player's right has had their turn, so everyone has had the same number of turns (see End of the game, page 16).

COMPONENTS

You can skip this page and come back to it when you need it.

Shared components



1 map



1 action grid



1 Congress board



6 senators



150 track tiles



20 each: Iron, Wood, Gunpowder, Coins



48 specialist tiles
Crew, Miner, Engineer, Financier



12 carriages



16 upgrade tiles



12 goal cards



3 scoring cards



1 score track
(0 to 99)



1 start player marker

In each of the four player colours



1 player board



11 houses



7 telegraph stations



6 workers



2 trains



2 cowboy hats



1 score marker, 1 +100 token

Pony Express expansion only (page 20)



10 milestone cards



17 Legislative Agenda cards



30 Pony Express tokens



38 Pony Express cards

Shared components

- 1 **map** (35 cities: 8 start cities and 27 inland cities)
- 1 **action grid** (9 districts)
- 1 **Congress board** (the Congress strip: 6 entries and Reset) and 6 **senators**
- 150 **track tiles**: 50 Ground, 50 Tunnel, 50 Bridge
- 20 each of **Iron**, **Wood**, **Gunpowder** and **Coins**
- 48 **specialist tiles**: 12 each of Crew, Miner, Engineer and Financier
- 12 **carriages**
- 16 **carriage upgrade tiles** (6 level 1, 5 level 2, 5 level 3)
- 12 **goal cards**
- 3 **scoring cards** (Ground, Tunnel, Bridge)
- 1 **score track** (0 to 99)
- 1 **start player marker**

In each of the four player colours

- 1 **player board**
- 11 **houses**
- 7 **telegraph stations**
- 6 **workers**
- 2 **trains**
- 2 **cowboy hats**
- 1 **score marker** and 1 **+100 token**

Pony Express expansion

Leave in the box for the core game; see page 20.

- 10 milestone cards
- 17 Legislative Agenda cards (numbered 4 to 20)
- 30 Pony Express tokens (27 for the inland cities, 3 spare)
- 38 Pony Express cards (13 rank 1, 11 rank 2, 14 rank 3)

REMINDER WHAT CAN RUN OUT

Only **specialist tiles** and **upgrade tiles** can run out: when all 12 of a specialist type have been hired, nobody can hire that type again, and each upgrade tile exists once and is never refilled. Track tiles, resources and Coins never run out: if one does, use a substitute. Each player has only 2 cowboy hats because that is the most anyone may hold (see Cowboy hats, page 8).

REMINDER THE SCORE TRACK

If your score passes 99, take your +100 token and keep counting from 0.

SETUP *the table*



A four-player table, ready to play. The numbered markers show where each step of Shared setup happens.

SHARED SETUP

1. **Map.** Lay out the map in the middle of the table.
2. **Action grid.** Put the action grid beside it.
3. **Congress.** Put the Congress board beside the grid. Put one **senator** on the **cost tile** (top row) of each of the six entries. A senator on its cost tile means "this entry is available". Reset has no senator.
4. **General supply.** Put the track tiles, Iron, Wood, Gunpowder, Coins, specialist tiles and the spare carriages within everyone's reach.
5. **Upgrades.** Lay all 16 carriage upgrade tiles face up beside the grid.
6. **Goals.** Shuffle the 12 goal cards and reveal 3. Return the rest to the box. Everybody is working towards these three for the whole game (page 17).
7. **Scoring card.** Shuffle the 3 scoring cards and reveal 1. For the whole game every slot of its terrain scores 3 VP when laid instead of 1 (page 17).
8. **Score track.** Put every player's score marker on 0.
9. **Start player.** Choose seats at random. Seat 1 is the **start player**: give them the start player marker, which they keep for the whole game. Play always goes clockwise, so seat 2 sits on seat 1's left, and so on.

Now each player sets up their own area (page 5).

REMINDER THE START PLAYER MARKER NEVER MOVES

There are no rounds to reset, but the marker still matters: the last seat (the player on the start player's right) always takes the last turn of the game, and the marker settles the final tie-break.

SETUP *the players*

Each player takes the components of one colour and sets them up in this exact state. The player board is shown in detail on page 6.

PLAYER SETUP

10 **Board and carriage.** Take your player board and 1 carriage. Put the carriage to the right of the player board: it is your **level 1** carriage.

11 **Workers.** Take workers according to the number of players: **2 players: 6 each; 3 players: 4 each; 4 players: 3 each.** Return any others to the box. There are always 12 workers in play, one for each worker space of the grid.

12 **Telegraph stations.** Put your 7 telegraph stations on the 7 slots of your telegraph pole.

13 **Trains, coins, resources.** Take your 2 trains, **1 Coin**, and put **1 Iron, 1 Wood and 1 Gunpowder** on storage spaces of your player board. You start with no cowboy hats.

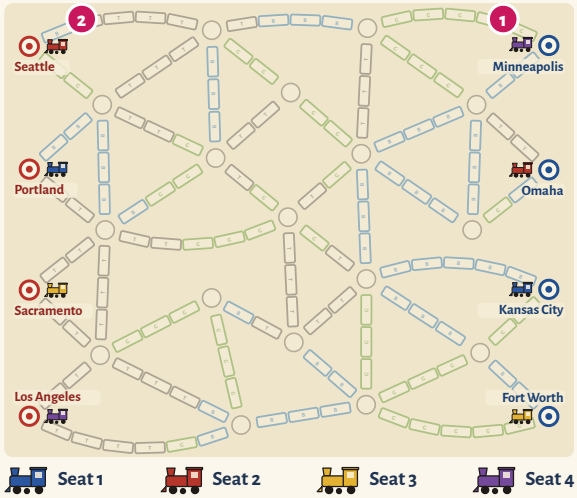
14 **Train draft.** First, in **reverse** seat order (last seat first), each player puts one train on any empty start city, west or east. Then, in seat order (seat 1 first), each player puts their second train on any empty start city on the **opposite** side from their first. You end with one train in the west and one in the east. Start cities nobody chose stay empty; they are ordinary start cities for the rest of the game.

15 **Starting choices.** In seat order, each player announces two choices:

- a. **Which house track starts with its "x2" slot empty.** Put your 11 houses on the other 11 house slots. That resource starts at production 2; the other three start at 1.
- b. **One specialist.** Take a Crew, Miner, Engineer or Financier from the supply for free and put it in the left specialist slot of your level 1 carriage.

16 **Late-seat bonus.** In seat order, the player in seat 2 takes 1 resource of their choice, seat 3 takes 1, and seat 4 takes 2. Put them in storage.

Seat 1 now takes the first turn. You are ready to play.



The eight start cities: four in the west (red rings), four in the east (blue rings). Trains as placed in the example below.

EXAMPLE THE TRAIN DRAFT

Four players. Seat 4 places first and takes **Minneapolis** 1. Seat 3 takes Sacramento, seat 2 Omaha, seat 1 Portland. Now in seat order: seat 1 must go east and takes Kansas City; seat 2 must go west and takes **Seattle** 2; seat 3 takes Fort Worth; seat 4 must go west and takes Los Angeles, the last west city.

REMINDER "A RESOURCE OF YOUR CHOICE"

Always means 1 Iron, 1 Wood or 1 Gunpowder. It is never a Coin.

CONCEPT WHERE THINGS START

After setup your player board shows: one empty "x2" slot, 11 houses, 7 telegraph stations, 3 resources (4 or 5 in later seats) in a storage of 9 spaces, and one specialist. Your 2 trains are on the map; your workers are in your supply beside your board.



One player after setup, having chosen Iron for the empty "x2" slot and a Crew as the starting specialist.

YOUR PLAYER BOARD



Your player board is your company's engine for turning resources into track. It has these parts (numbers match the picture).

1 Telegraph pole. Holds your 7 telegraph stations. You always take the lowest one still on the pole and score the VP printed on the slot it leaves (page 15).

2 Foreman. Always on your engine. He works in every board activation, taking the type of the district that started it (page 10).

3 Cowboy hat spaces. Room for your cowboy hats, at most 2 (page 8).

4 House tracks and production. Each of the four tracks, Wood, Iron, Gunpowder and Coins, has three house slots printed x2, x3, x4. Your **production** of that resource is shown by the rightmost empty slot: **x2, x3 or x4. With no empty slot, production is 1.** Houses always leave a track from the left (x2 first, then x3, then x4), so production rises 1, 2, 3, 4. A house leaves your board only by becoming a railway station on the map (page 15).



5 8 Storage. Your player board has **6 storage spaces** and every carriage adds **3**. You start with 9 spaces; with 3 carriages you have 15.

- Each Iron, Wood, Gunpowder and each built track tile fills one space. Coins and cowboy hats take no space; keep your Coins beside your board.
- All your storage is one pool: it does not matter which space an item sits on.
- **Overflow:** whenever your stored items are more than your spaces, on your turn or not, immediately discard items of your choice (resources or built tiles, old or new) to the supply until they fit. You gain nothing for a discard. You may never discard at any other time.

6 Specialists. Each carriage has two specialist slots, filled left to right. There are four types:

Specialist	When it works
Crew	pay 2 Iron: build 1 Ground tile
Miner	pay 2 Gunpowder: build 1 Tunnel tile
Engineer	pay 2 Wood: build 1 Bridge tile
Financier	gain 1 **lobby point** (no cost)

A specialist never moves and is never removed. How to hire more: Hire Specialist, page 9.

7 Upgrade plate. Each carriage can hold one carriage upgrade tile (page 14).

Carriages. You may have at most **3**. They are numbered in the order you add them: your starting carriage is **level 1**, the next is level 2, the third level 3. The level sets the order in which carriages work (page 10) and which upgrade tiles fit (page 14). A new carriage's 3 storage spaces count at once. You add carriages with the Add Carriage bonus action (page 9) or a Congress entry (page 11).

REMINDER WHICH WAY ROUND

Iron → Ground

Gunpowder → Tunnel

Wood → Bridge

Remember the pairings: **Iron → Ground**, **Gunpowder → Tunnel**, **Wood → Bridge**. Every recipe costs 2 of one resource.

YOUR TURN *and the worker step*

Players take turns one at a time, clockwise, until the game ends. There are no rounds and nothing to reset between turns.

YOUR TURN

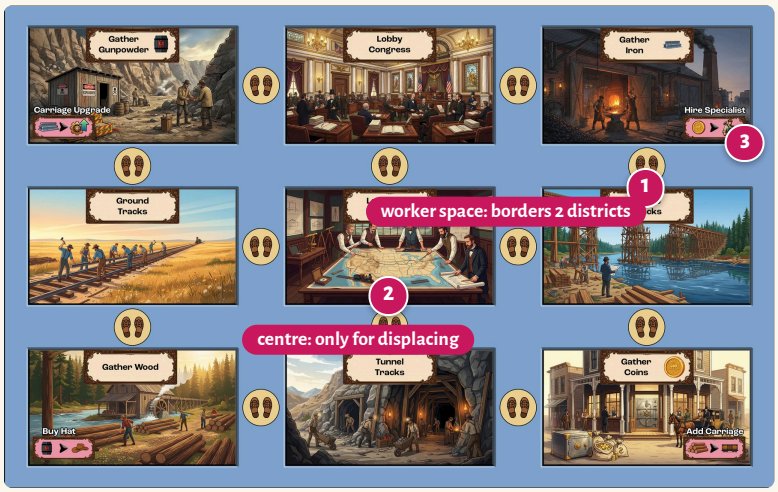
1. **Worker step.** Do exactly one: **Place** a worker, **Remove** a worker, or **Displace** (page 8).
2. **Choose the action.** Choose one district your worker gives you, and say whether you spend a cowboy hat (page 8).
3. **Resolve the action** with its multiplier: Gather (page 9), a board activation (page 10) or Lay Tracks / Move Train (pages 12 and 13).
4. **End of turn.** Check whether the game end is triggered (page 16). The player on your left begins.

You may not pass, and you may not skip steps 1 or 2 (one rare exception: page 18).

THE ACTION GRID

The grid has **9 districts** in a 3 x 3 square. Each district offers one action. Two districts are **neighbours** if they touch along an edge: above, below, left or right, never diagonally. Between every two neighbouring districts is a **worker space** (a pair of footprints): 12 in all. A worker space holds one worker and always borders exactly two districts. Each district also has a **centre**, used only when you displace (page 8).

Gather Gunpowder	Lobby Congress	Gather Iron
Ground Tracks	Lay Tracks / Move Train	Bridge Tracks
Gather Wood	Tunnel Tracks	Gather Coins



The action grid: **12 worker spaces, 9 centres.** 3 *marks a printed bonus action (Hire Specialist, page 9).*

PLACE

Put one worker from your supply on any empty worker space 1. Then choose **one** of the two districts it borders and take that action.

REMOVE

Take one of your workers off the grid back to your supply. If it stood on a worker space, choose **one** of the two districts that space borders and take that action. If it stood on a district centre, take that district's action.

- If you have a worker on any district centre, the worker you remove **must** be one of those.

Place or remove: your choice. You may place while you still have workers on the grid and you may remove while you still have workers in supply. There is no need to place all your workers first. If all your workers are on the grid, you must remove.

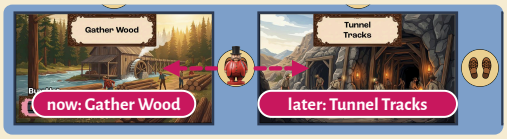
Which actions you can choose. A Gather action and a board activation can always be chosen, even if you then do nothing with it. **Lay Tracks / Move Train** can be chosen only if you have at least one route you can lay or one move you can make (pages 12 and 13).

Open information. Everything on the table is open: anyone may look at any player's board, Coins and hats at any time.

REMINDER YOUR WORKERS STAY OUT

A placed worker stays on the grid until you remove it on a later turn. While it is there it blocks that space for everyone and helps your multiplier (page 8). Removing it later gives you a second action from the same spot.

EXAMPLE PLACE AND REMOVE



Cara places a worker between Gather Wood and Tunnel Tracks and chooses Gather Wood. Three turns later she removes that worker and this time chooses Tunnel Tracks.

DISPLACING *the multiplier and cowboy hats*

DISPLACE

When a district is completely surrounded by rivals, you may break in. You may put a worker from your supply on the **centre** of a district only if **all** of these are true:

- every worker space of that district is occupied;
- none of those workers is yours;
- you have no worker adjacent to that district (see below);
- its centre is empty.

Then:

1. Every worker on that district's worker spaces goes back to its owner's supply. (Workers on centres are not affected.)
2. Each owner gains **1 cowboy hat for each worker returned**, or 1 resource of their choice instead if they already hold 2 hats. Resolve this player by player, starting on your left.
3. You take that district's action.

Your worker stays on the centre. It counts as adjacent to that district and to its neighbours, and the next worker you remove must be it (page 7).

EXAMPLE DISPLACEMENT



All four worker spaces around Lay Tracks / Move Train are taken: two of Ivy's workers, one of Jo's, one of Kim's. Lou has no worker adjacent to it. Ivy holds 1 hat, Jo 2, Kim 0.

1. Lou puts a worker on the centre.
2. The four workers go home. Ivy is owed 2 hats: she gains 1 (now 2) and takes 1 resource of her choice for the second. Jo already holds 2 and takes 1 resource. Kim gains 1 hat.
3. Lou takes Lay Tracks / Move Train with multiplier 1 (or 2 with a hat).

THE MULTIPLIER

Every action has a **multiplier (M)**, worked out once when you choose the action:

> **M = 1 + your other workers adjacent to the chosen district + 1 if you spend a cowboy hat.**

A worker is **adjacent** to a district if it stands on one of that district's worker spaces, on its centre, or on the centre of a neighbouring district. The worker you used this turn is the "1" and never counts again. Rivals' workers never change your multiplier.

ACTION	WHAT M DOES
Gather	You gain production x M
Board activation	Your Foreman (only him) works M times
Lay Tracks / Move Train	You take M steps

EXAMPLE WORKING OUT M



Blue has workers between Gather Iron and Bridge Tracks 1 and between Bridge Tracks and Gather Coins 2. Blue places a worker between Lay Tracks / Move Train and Bridge Tracks 3 and chooses Bridge Tracks: both other workers border it, so **M = 1 + 2 = 3**, or 4 with a hat. Had Blue chosen Lay Tracks / Move Train instead, neither other worker borders it: M = 1.

COWBOY HATS

- You may hold **at most 2**. Whenever you would gain a hat while holding 2, take 1 resource of your choice instead.
- When you choose your action you may spend **1 hat** (never more) to add 1 to M. It works on any action.
- You may spend only a hat you held **when your turn began**. A hat gained during this turn, from any source, waits for a later turn.
- Hats are worth nothing at the end of the game.

You gain hats by being displaced, with the Buy Hat bonus action (page 9), from a Congress entry (page 11) and from some upgrade tiles (page 14).

GATHER *and the bonus actions*

The four Gather districts are **Gather Iron**, **Gather Wood**, **Gather Gunpowder** and **Gather Coins**.

Yield. Gain **production x M** of that district's resource (production: page 6). Resources go into storage (watch for overflow); Coins go beside your board.

Bonus action. Each Gather district prints a bonus action. After taking your yield you may take that bonus action **once**, paying its cost. Resources you have just gathered may pay for it. If you cannot pay the whole cost, or cannot carry out the effect at all, you cannot take it.



Gather Gunpowder

CARRIAGE UPGRADE *at Gather Gunpowder*

Pay **1 Iron**. Take one upgrade tile from the display and install it on one of your carriages (rules on page 14).



Gather Iron

HIRE SPECIALIST *at Gather Iron*

Pay **1 Coin** and hire one specialist. That is the whole cost, whatever the type and whatever the carriage.

1. It goes into the **lowest-level carriage with an empty specialist slot**, left slot before right. You may not choose the carriage or leave a gap. If no slot is empty, you cannot hire.
2. Choose any type whose tiles are still in the supply. You may hire the same type as often as you like.

A card that lets you hire "for free" skips the 1 Coin; steps 1 and 2 still apply.



Gather Wood

BUY HAT *at Gather Wood*

Pay **1 Gunpowder**: gain 1 cowboy hat. Not allowed if you already hold 2.



Gather Coins

ADD CARRIAGE *at Gather Coins*

Pay **1 Wood**: take a carriage from the supply and put it at the end of your player board. It takes the next level. Not allowed if you already have 3. Its specialist slots stay empty until every slot in your earlier carriages is filled.

CONCEPT GROWING YOUR BOARD

To build more, add carriages and fill their slots: 3 carriages hold 6 specialists (each works once, page 10).

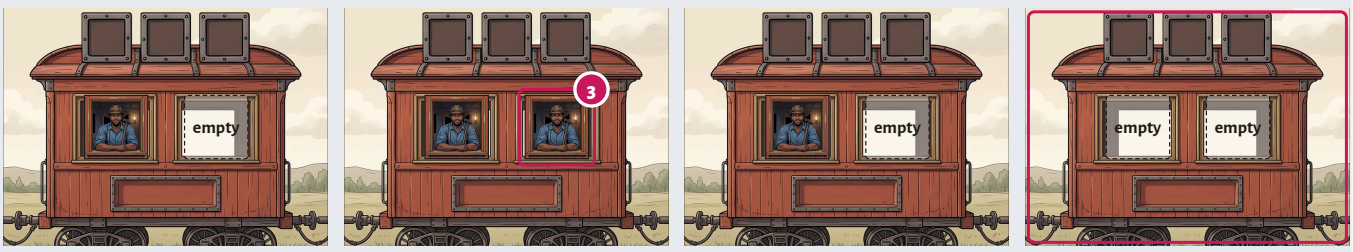
EXAMPLE GATHER IRON AND HIRE A SPECIALIST

Anna left her Iron "x2" slot empty, so her Iron production is 2. She has a Crew in her level 1 carriage, holds 1 Iron, 1 Wood, 1 Gunpowder (3 of 9 spaces) and 1 Coin. One of her workers already stands between Gather Iron and Bridge Tracks.

1. She places a worker between Lobby Congress and Gather Iron and chooses Gather Iron. Her other worker borders it: M = 1 + 1 = 2.
2. Yield: 2 x 2 = **4 Iron**. Storage: 5 Iron, 1 Wood, 1 Gunpowder (7 of 9).
3. Hire Specialist: the new specialist must go in the right slot of her level 1 carriage. Any type costs the same 1 Coin; she pays it and hires a second Crew.
4. Result: 0 Coins; storage 5 Iron, 1 Wood, 1 Gunpowder (7 of 9); carriage: Crew, Crew.

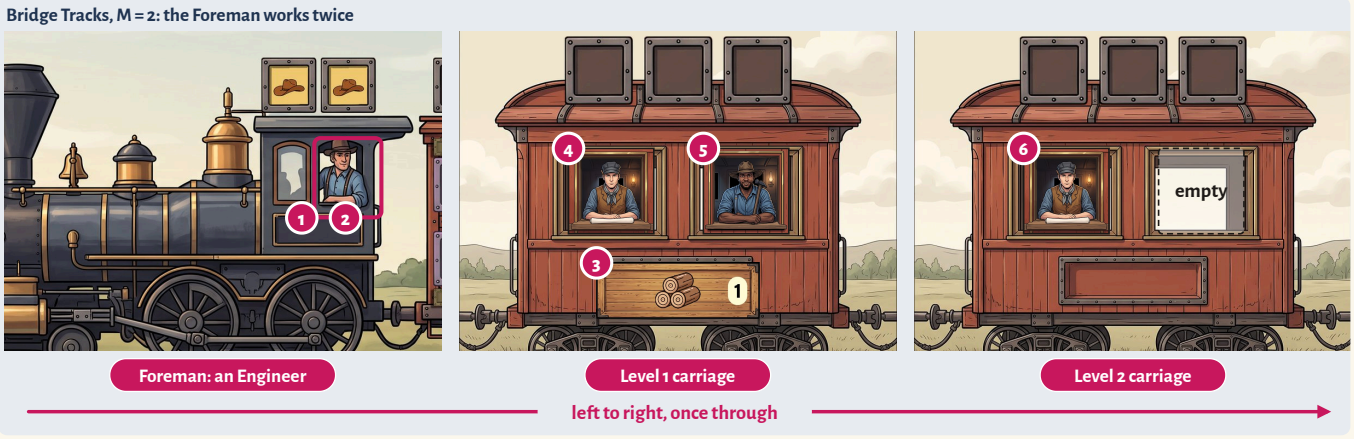
EXAMPLE ADD CARRIAGE

Dev places a worker between Tunnel Tracks and Gather Coins, chooses Gather Coins with M = 1 and Coin production 1: he gains 1 Coin. He pays 1 Wood for Add Carriage. It is his second carriage, so it is level 2, and his storage grows from 9 to 12 at once. His level 1 carriage still has an empty slot, so his next hire goes there.



Two carriages. *Anna's new Crew goes in the right slot of her level 1 carriage (step 3 of her example). Dev's new carriage takes the next level, 2; his next hire still goes into the empty slot of his level 1 carriage.*

BOARD ACTIVATION *building track tiles*



Eve's board *at Bridge Tracks: markers 1 to 6 show the order in which her pieces work (the example below).*

Four districts start a **board activation**: **Ground Tracks**, **Tunnel Tracks**, **Bridge Tracks** and **Lobby Congress**. A board activation runs through your whole player board once, left to right: the Foreman (M times), then each carriage.

The Foreman takes the district's type for the whole activation: a **Crew** at Ground Tracks, a **Miner** at Tunnel Tracks, an **Engineer** at Bridge Tracks, a **Financier** at Lobby Congress. So you can always build at a track district, even with no matching specialist.

How many times each piece works. Your **Foreman works M times**. Every **specialist works once**, whatever the level of its carriage.

THE ACTIVATION, IN ORDER

1. The **Foreman**, M times.
2. Then for each carriage, level 1, then 2, then 3:
   - its **upgrade tile**, if any, once (page 14);
   - its **left specialist**, once;
   - its **right specialist**, once.

Each time a **Crew, Miner or Engineer** works (the Foreman included), choose **use** or **skip**. To use, pay its 2 resources from storage to the supply and put 1 built tile of its type into storage. You may only use if you can pay. Each time a **Financier** works, gain 1 lobby point (page 11); there is no cost and no choice.

You may not change the order, and a skipped step is gone. Anything you gain during the activation (from an upgrade tile or Congress) may pay for later steps of the same activation. Check overflow after every step (page 6).

REMINDER BUILT TILES WAIT IN STORAGE

A board activation **never** puts anything on the map. Your built tiles stay in storage until you take the Lay Tracks action (page 12).

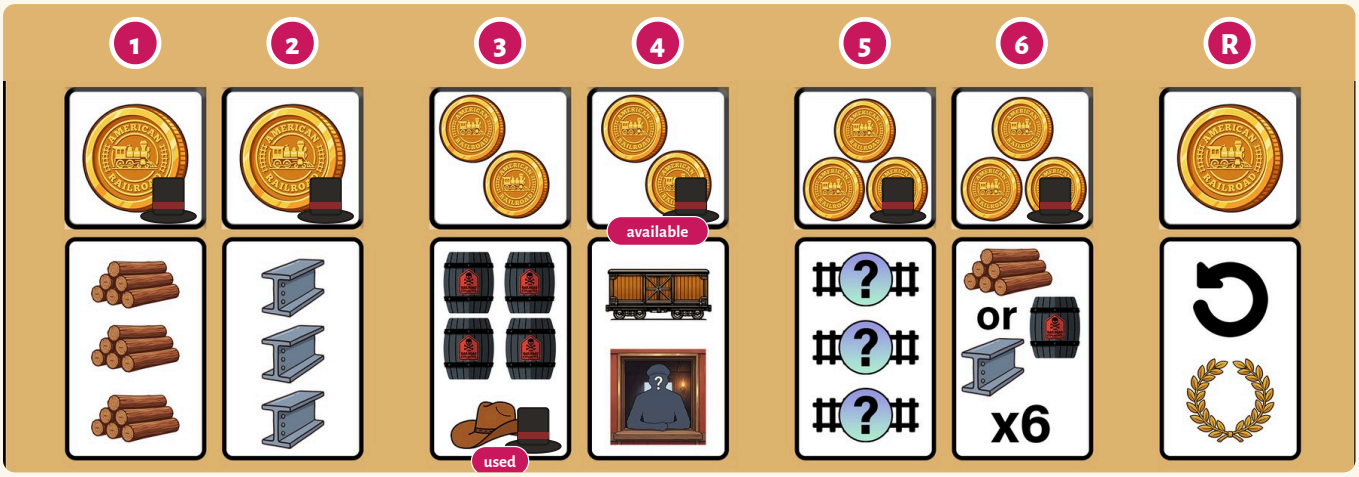
EXAMPLE EVE ACTIVATES AT BRIDGE TRACKS

Eve's level 1 carriage has the Wood Tender, an Engineer (left) and a Crew (right); her level 2 carriage has an Engineer (left) and an empty right slot. Eve holds 5 Wood and 2 Iron (7 of 12 spaces: 6 on the board and 3 on each of her two carriages). One of her workers stands between Bridge Tracks and Gather Coins.

1. She places a worker between Lay Tracks / Move Train and Bridge Tracks and chooses Bridge Tracks: **M = 2**. Her Foreman is an Engineer.
2. Order: Foreman, Foreman, Wood Tender, Engineer, Crew, Engineer (level 2).
3. Foreman (1): pays 2 Wood, builds 1 Bridge. Storage: 3 Wood, 2 Iron, 1 Bridge.
4. Foreman again (2): pays 2 Wood, builds 1 Bridge. Storage: 1 Wood, 2 Iron, 2 Bridge.
5. Wood Tender (3): gains 1 Wood. Storage: 2 Wood, 2 Iron, 2 Bridge.
6. Engineer, level 1 (4): pays 2 Wood, builds 1 Bridge. Storage: 2 Iron, 3 Bridge.
7. Crew (5): pays 2 Iron, builds 1 Ground. Storage: 3 Bridge, 1 Ground.
8. Engineer, level 2 (6): she has no Wood, so she must skip.

Result: **3 Bridge and 1 Ground built**, 4 of 12 spaces used. Nothing has gone on the map.

LOBBY CONGRESS



The Congress strip *(the top of the Congress board). Top row: the cost tile of each entry (a senator waiting there means the entry is available). Bottom row: the benefit tile. Markers 1 to 6 are the entries, R is Reset; entry 3 is used.*

The Congress strip is shared by everybody. You buy its **entries** with **lobby points** and Coins during a board activation.

Lobby points come only from Financier steps of a board activation: your Foreman at the Lobby Congress district (M of them), and your Financier specialists in **any** board activation, including one started at a track district. Each Financier step gives 1 lobby point. Count them in your head: lobby points never outlast the activation.

Entry	Tier: lobby points	Coins	Benefit
1	1	1	Gain 3 Wood
2	1	1	Gain 3 Iron
3	2	2	Gain 4 Gunpowder and 1 cowboy hat
4	2	2	Add 1 carriage and hire 1 specialist, both free
5	3	3	Gain 3 built track tiles of any types (same or different)
6	3	3	Gain 6 resources of your choice
Reset	1	1	Return every used senator; gain 1 VP for each

Taking an entry. After any step of a board activation in which you hold at least 1 lobby point, you may take any number of available entries, one at a time. For each:

1. spend lobby points equal to its tier;
2. pay its Coins to the supply;
3. slide its senator down onto the benefit tile (the entry is now **used**);
4. resolve the benefit completely.

You may also keep lobby points for later steps. When the last step is done you get one final chance to take entries; then any lobby points left are lost.

Used entries. Nobody can take a used entry until somebody takes **Reset**. Reset costs 1 lobby point and 1 Coin, returns every senator on a benefit tile to its cost tile, and scores 1 VP per senator moved. Reset can be taken only when at least one entry is used.

Benefits. Gained resources and built tiles go into storage. For **entry 4**, add the carriage first, then hire 1 specialist for free under the normal hiring rule (page 9): it goes into the lowest-level carriage with an empty slot, so it lands in slot 1 of the new carriage only when your other carriages are full. You may skip the hire, but you cannot take entry 4 if you already have 3 carriages. For **entry 6**, choose each of the 6 resources: Iron, Wood or Gunpowder, mixed as you like, never Coins.

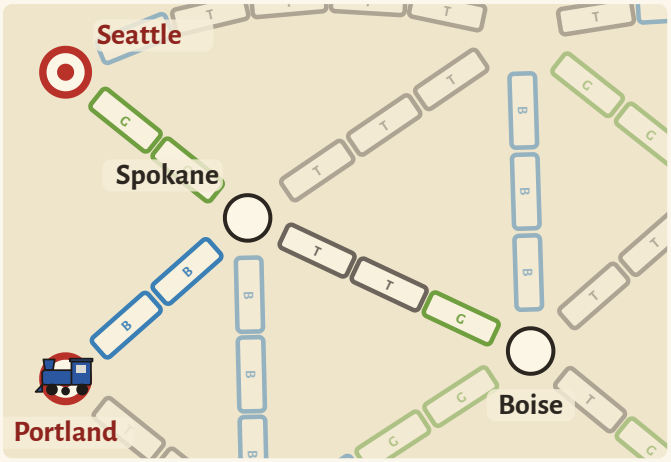
EXAMPLE FINN LOBBIES CONGRESS

Finn has a Financier and a Miner in his level 1 carriage, 4 Coins and no Gunpowder. All six entries are available. He places a worker between Lobby Congress and Lay Tracks / Move Train and chooses Lobby Congress: M = 1, his Foreman is a Financier.

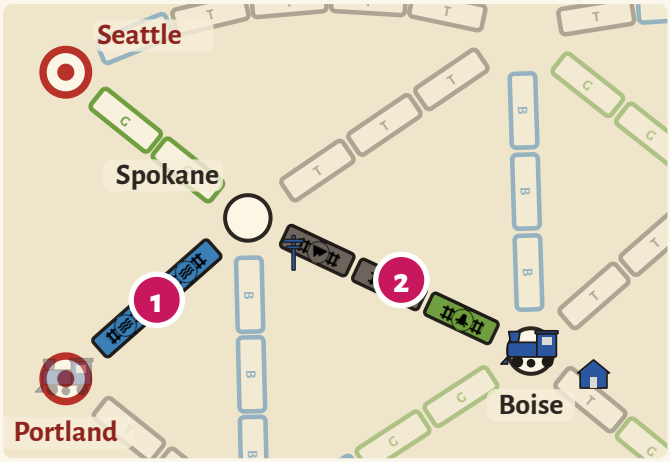
1. Foreman: 1 lobby point. He could take entry 1 or 2 now, but keeps the point.
2. Financier: 2 lobby points. He takes **entry 3** (2 points, 2 Coins): 4 Gunpowder and 1 cowboy hat. Coins left: 2. Lobby points: 0.
3. Miner: pays 2 of the Gunpowder he just gained and builds 1 Tunnel. He keeps 2 Gunpowder.

Entry 3 now stays used until someone takes Reset. (Instead, he could have taken entry 1 after step 1 and entry 2 after step 2: 3 Wood and 3 Iron for 2 Coins.)

LAY TRACKS *laying routes*



Before. *Gus's train is on Portland.*
Gus's storage: 2 2 1



After his two steps. *Laid tiles belong to nobody; only his buildings are his.*
Gus's storage: empty

The **Lay Tracks / Move Train** district gives you **M steps**. Each step either **lays one route** (this page) or **moves one train** (page 13), your choice each time. You must take at least one step and may stop after any step. Each step is finished before the next begins, so a train that has just advanced can lay another route on the next step.

The map. Cities are joined by **routes**. Each route is a chain of 2 to 6 **slots**, and each slot shows a terrain: Ground, Tunnel or Bridge. The 8 cities on the map edges are **start cities** (4 west, 4 east); the other 27 are **inland cities**.

Which routes you can lay. You may lay a route when:

1. nobody has laid it yet;
2. one of your trains stands on a city at one end of it; and
3. your storage holds a built tile **matching every slot**. A route printed Ground, Tunnel, Tunnel needs exactly 1 Ground and 2 Tunnel tiles. There are no wild tiles and no part payment.

LAYING A ROUTE

1. **Pay.** Put the matching built tiles from your storage onto the route's slots. The route is now laid. It belongs to nobody: you score it now, and nobody can ever lay it again.
2. **Track VP.** Score **1 VP per slot**, or **3 VP per slot of the scoring card's terrain**.
3. **Advance.** Move that train along the route to the city at the other end, the **arrival city**.
4. **First connection.** If the arrival city is an inland city that no laid route touched before, score **5 VP**.
5. **Toll.** If the arrival city has a rival's railway station, that rival scores 3 VP (page 13).
6. **Transcontinental check** (page 16).
7. **Free building.** If the arrival city is an inland city with room, you may place one building there: a railway station or a telegraph station (page 15).

EXAMPLE GUS LAYS TRACKS

(the scoring card this game is **Bridge**)

Gus's train is on Portland; his storage holds 2 Bridge, 2 Tunnel and 1 Ground. No route has been laid yet. He removes his worker from between Ground Tracks and Lay Tracks / Move Train and chooses Lay Tracks / Move Train. His worker between Lay Tracks / Move Train and Tunnel Tracks is adjacent: **M = 2**, two steps.

1. **Step 1: he lays Portland-Spokane** (Bridge, Bridge), paying 2 Bridge. Track VP 2 x 3 = **6**. Train to Spokane. First connection: **5**. No toll. He places a telegraph station, the lowest on his pole: **1**. Step total 12.
2. **Step 2: he lays Spokane-Boise** (Ground, Tunnel, Tunnel) from the city his train has just reached, paying 1 Ground and 2 Tunnel. Track VP **3** (no Bridge slots). Train to Boise. First connection: **5**. He places a railway station, taking the leftmost house from his Wood track. Step total 8.
3. Turn total: **20 VP**. His storage is empty.
4. Later Hal, whose train is on Seattle, lays Seattle-Spokane (Ground, Ground): 2 VP. Spokane is already connected, so no first connection; it has no railway station, so no toll. Hal may place a railway station there: the city still has room for one.

REMINDER A ROUTE IS LAID WHOLE

You lay a whole route or nothing. A laid route is never removed and can never be laid again. A train on a city with no unlaid route cannot lay one: move it first.

MOVE TRAIN *and tolls*

A **move** is the other kind of step of the Lay Tracks / Move Train action.

A legal move. Choose one of your trains and a different city it can reach along a chain of **laid** routes. It does not matter who laid them. There is no limit on distance, and the destination may be any city, start or inland.

Choose your path. You choose the path, any chain of laid routes to your destination that enters no city twice. The cities **entered** are every city on the path after the one you left, including the destination.

Tolls. For each city entered that holds a **rival's railway station**, its owner scores **3 VP** from the bank. You lose nothing. Each city counts once per move. Your own railway stations and all telegraph stations take no toll. Laying a route that brings your train into a city with a rival's railway station also scores that rival 3 VP (page 12).

Building on arrival. After a move you may pay **2 Coins** to place one building in the destination, if it is an inland city with room for it (page 15).

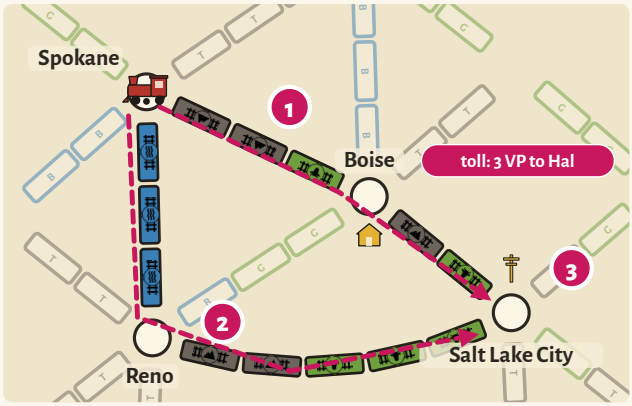
Trains share. Any number of trains, yours or anybody's, may stand on the same city. A train on a city that no laid route touches cannot move.

CONCEPT **LAY OR MOVE, STEP BY STEP**

With M = 3 you might move a train next to the route you want, lay it, and lay another from the arrival city. With M = 1 you get one route laid **or** one move, never both.

HISTORY **THE SURVEYORS**

Before a mile of track went down, survey parties walked the line. Theodore Judah found the Central Pacific's way over the Sierra Nevada near Donner Pass, and Union Pacific surveyors probed the passes of the Rockies, often under threat of attack, choosing routes that would decide where towns would grow.



Ivy's two paths *from Spokane to Salt Lake City over four laid routes. 1: via Boise (Hal's railway station, a toll). 2: via Reno. 3: where she builds, beside Hal's telegraph station.*

EXAMPLE **IVY MOVES**

Ivy's train is on Spokane and she has 3 Coins. She takes Lay Tracks / Move Train with M = 1 and uses her step to move to Salt Lake City.

1. Path A runs Spokane - Boise - Salt Lake City. Boise holds Hal's railway station, so Hal would score 3 VP.
2. Path B runs Spokane - Reno - Salt Lake City. Reno has no railway station. Ivy chooses path B: nobody scores a toll. Salt Lake City has only Hal's telegraph station, which takes no toll.
3. She pays 2 Coins (1 left) and places a railway station in Salt Lake City, taking the leftmost house from her Iron track: her Iron production rises by 1. Her train can lay a route from Salt Lake City on a later step or turn.



CARRIAGE UPGRADES

Carriage upgrades are tiles you fit to your carriages. They work every time you activate your player board. You install one with the **Carriage Upgrade** bonus action at Gather Gunpowder (page 9).

Installing a tile. Choose a tile from the display and one of your carriages. The carriage must:

1. hold at least one specialist;
2. have an empty upgrade plate; and
3. be at least the tile's level (a level 1 tile fits any carriage; a level 3 tile fits only your level 3 carriage).

Installing has no immediate effect. An installed tile is never moved, replaced or removed, so you can install at most 3 in a game. Tiles are first come, first served and are not refilled.

EXAMPLE BEN FITS AN UPGRADE

Ben holds 1 cowboy hat and 2 Iron; he has a Miner in his level 1 carriage and its upgrade plate is empty. His Gunpowder production is 1.

1. He removes his worker from between Gather Gunpowder and Lobby Congress and chooses Gather Gunpowder. No other worker of his is adjacent, but he spends his hat: M = 1 + 0 + 1 = 2. Yield 1 x 2 = 2 Gunpowder.
2. Carriage Upgrade: he pays 1 Iron, takes the **Gunpowder Tender** and installs it in his level 1 carriage.
3. From now on, every board activation gives him 1 Gunpowder just before his level 1 specialists work.

When a tile works. In every board activation, each tile works **once**, when the activation reaches its carriage: after the previous carriage has finished and before its own carriage's specialists work. The Foreman's extra activations from M do not repeat it. Items you gain follow the usual storage and hat limits.

Bounty tiles (level 2) are worked out when the activation has finished: 1 VP for each tile of that type your Foreman and specialists **built** in this activation. Tiles gained from Congress or a Works tile do not count.

EXAMPLE A BOUNTY

Eve's level 1 carriage holds an Engineer and a Financier; her level 2 carriage holds Bridge Bounty and two Financiers. At Bridge Tracks with M = 2 her Foreman builds 2 Bridge tiles and her Engineer builds 1. Her three Financiers give her 3 lobby points, and she pays 3 Coins for Congress entry 5: 3 built Bridge tiles. At the end of the activation Bridge Bounty scores **3 VP**: the 3 tiles from Congress were not built.

THE 16 CARRIAGE UPGRADE TILES *(EACH WORKS ONCE PER BOARD ACTIVATION)*

LEVEL 1

ENGINE POWER	WOOD TENDER	IRON TENDER	COIN TENDER	GUNPOWDER TENDER	HAT BOX
Gain 2 VP	Gain 1 Wood	Gain 1 Iron	Gain 1 Coin	Gain 1 Gunpowder	Gain 1 cowboy hat

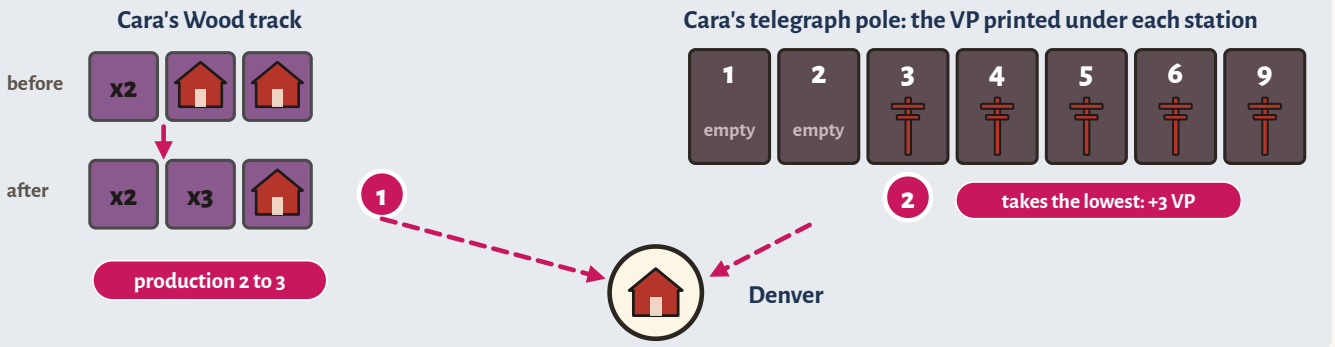
LEVEL 2

ADVANCED ENGINE	BRIDGE BOUNTY	TUNNEL BOUNTY	GROUND BOUNTY	OUTFITTER
Gain 3 VP	Gain 1 VP for each Bridge tile built in this activation	Gain 1 VP for each Tunnel tile built in this activation	Gain 1 VP for each Ground tile built in this activation	Gain 1 cowboy hat

LEVEL 3

FLAGSHIP ENGINE	BRIDGE WORKS	TUNNEL WORKS	GROUND WORKS	HATTER'S CAR
Gain 4 VP	Gain 1 built Bridge tile	Gain 1 built Tunnel tile	Gain 1 built Ground tile	Gain 1 cowboy hat

RAILWAY STATIONS *and telegraph stations*



Railway stations and telegraph stations are your two kinds of **building**. Buildings exist only on the map and only in the 27 **inland cities**: never in a start city. Each inland city has room for exactly **one railway station** and **one telegraph station** (the telegraph station sits beneath the railway station). One player may own both buildings of a city.

Placing a railway station.

1. The city must have no railway station, and you must have at least one house left on your player board.
2. Choose any house track that still has a house and take the **leftmost** house on it. Put it in the city: it is now a railway station.
3. Your production of that track's resource rises by 1 at once.
4. A railway station scores no VP when placed. It scores tolls during play and counts as a building at the end.

Placing a telegraph station.

1. The city must have no telegraph station, and you must have at least one left on your pole.
2. Take the **lowest** telegraph station from your pole and put it in the city.
3. Score at once the VP printed on the slot it left: **1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, then 9**.

Ways to place a building. You may place a building:

- **after laying a route**, in the arrival city, for free, one per route laid (page 12);
- **after a move**, in the destination, for 2 Coins, one per move (page 13).

Every building placement is optional. A building placed after laying a route does not need a first connection: any route you lay that brings your train into an inland city with room allows it.

Buildings never move, are never removed and never change owner.

EXAMPLE **CARA BUILDS**

Cara's Wood "x2" slot has been empty since setup (production 2), and she has placed two telegraph stations.

1. A route she lays brings her train into Denver, which is empty. She places a railway station, taking the leftmost house on her Wood track (the x3). Now x2 and x3 are empty: Wood production **3**.
2. On a later turn another route she lays brings a train into Denver again. The railway station is there, so only a telegraph station can go in. She places her third: **3 VP**.

REMINDER **TWO KINDS OF REWARD**

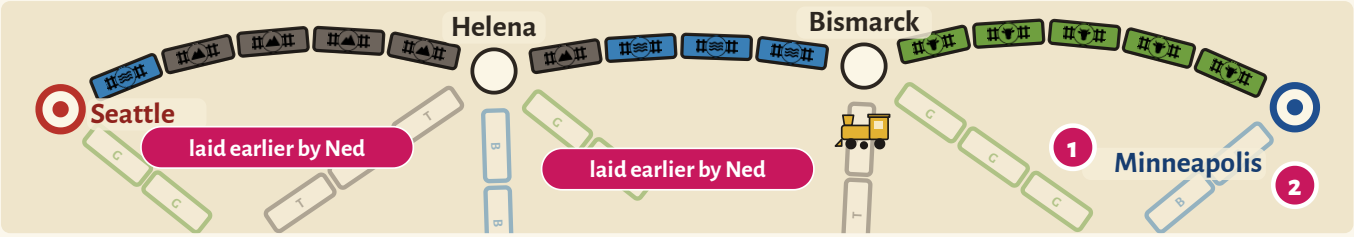
A **railway station** pays you later: tolls, more production, and building VP at the end. A **telegraph station** pays you now: its pole value. Both count as buildings at the end (page 16).

HISTORY **THE WIRE**

The railroads strung their own telegraph wire beside the track as it advanced, and used it to run their trains. At Promontory a single word, "DONE", went out over the wire the moment the last spike was struck, and cities from San Francisco to New York celebrated at once.



END OF THE GAME *and final scoring*



The golden spike. *Mia lays the third route (1), which completes the line to Minneapolis (2). The tiles are plain terrain tiles.*

WHAT ENDS THE GAME

A transcontinental line. A transcontinental line is any chain of laid routes, laid by anyone, that joins a west start city to an east start city. The **first** time in the game a route you lay completes one, you score **25 VP plus 3 VP for each slot of that route** (on top of its track VP), however much of the line other players laid, and the game end is triggered. This happens only once per game: a later line scores nothing extra.

A crowded map. At the end of any turn, if the number of laid routes is at least **8 per player** (16 with 2 players, 24 with 3, 32 with 4), the game end is triggered. Nobody scores a bonus for this.

Finishing. Once the end is triggered, play on until the player in the last seat (on the start player's right) has finished their turn, so everyone has had the same number of turns. If the last seat triggered it, the game ends with that turn. Until then everything works as normal.

EXAMPLE THE GOLDEN SPIKE

(four players; the scoring card is Tunnel)

Ned has laid Seattle-Helena and Mia has laid Helena-Bismarck. Mia, in seat 3, has a train on Bismarck and holds 5 built Ground tiles.

1. She lays Bismarck-Minneapolis (5 Ground slots): **5** track VP. Minneapolis is a start city: no first connection, no toll, no building.
2. Laid routes now join Seattle to Minneapolis, and nobody has done it before. Ned laid part of the line, but Mia laid the route that completed it: **25 + 3 x 5 = 40 VP**. Her turn scores 45 VP and triggers the end.
3. Seat 4 takes one more turn, then the game ends.

FINAL SCORING

Add to your score, in this order:

1. **Buildings.** Count your railway stations and telegraph stations on the map and score from the table.
2. **Goals.** Score each of the three goal cards (page 17).

Nothing else scores: leftover resources, built tiles, Coins, hats, specialists, carriages and workers are worth nothing.

Winner. The most VP wins. If tied, the tied player with the most buildings on the map wins; if still tied, the most Iron, Wood, Gunpowder and built tiles in storage; then the one closest to the start player in turn order (the start player is closest).

Buildings	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
VP	0	2	4	7	10	14	18	23	28	34

Buildings	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
VP	40	47	54	62	70	79	88	98	108

EXAMPLE FINAL SCORING

(three players; goals: Most Railway Stations, Economic Efficiency, Specialist Army)

	Anna	Ben	Cara
Score when the game ends	112	131	112
Buildings (railway + telegraph)	5 + 4 = 9: **34**	3 + 4 = 7: **23**	5 + 6 = 11: **47**
Most Railway Stations (5 / 3 / 5)	tied 1st: **10**	2nd: **5**	tied 1st: **10**
Economic Efficiency, fewest in storage (3 / 0 / 5)	2nd: **5**	1st: **10**	3rd: 0
Specialist Army (6 / 4 / 4)	1st: **10**	tied 2nd: **5**	tied 2nd: **5**
Total	**171**	**174**	**174**

Ben and Cara tie on 174. Cara has 11 buildings to Ben's 7, so **Cara wins**.

GOAL CARDS *and the scoring card*

GOAL CARDS

Three goal cards are revealed at setup. Nothing happens with them during play: they score in final scoring.

Scoring a goal. Rank the players by the card's measure. **First place scores 10 VP, second place 5 VP**; third and fourth score nothing.

- Players tied for a place each score that place's full VP. If two or more tie for first, each scores 10 and second place still goes to the next-best measure.
- On a "most" goal, a player whose measure is 0 scores nothing.
- **With 2 players only first place scores.**

THE 12 GOAL CARDS *(THREE ARE REVEALED EACH GAME; THE HIGHEST MEASURE RANKS FIRST, EXCEPT GOAL 10)*



1 MOST RAILWAY STATIONS
Your railway stations on the map



2 CONTINENTAL SPAN
The smaller of: your buildings in **North** cities, your buildings in **South** cities (page 18)



3 STRATEGIC POSITIONS
Your buildings in **junction cities** (page 18)



4 SPECIALIST FOCUS
Your specialists of the one type you have most of



5 ROLLING STOCK
Your carriages (1 to 3)



6 UPGRADE MASTERY
Upgrade tiles installed on your carriages



7 DIVERSIFIED COMPANY
Your complete sets of Crew, Miner, Engineer and Financier (the smallest of the four counts)



8 SPECIALIST ARMY
Your specialists (the Foreman does not count)



9 OPPORTUNISTIC BUILDER
Your telegraph stations in cities whose railway station belongs to a rival



10 ECONOMIC EFFICIENCY
Fewest Iron, Wood, Gunpowder and built tiles in your storage (Coins and hats do not count)



11 MOST TELEGRAPH STATIONS
Your telegraph stations on the map



12 CITY PRESENCE
Inland cities holding at least one of your buildings

THE SCORING CARD

One scoring card is revealed every game: **Ground**, **Tunnel** or **Bridge**. For the whole game, for every player, **each slot of that terrain scores 3 VP when laid**; every other slot scores 1 VP.



Ground *Tunnel* *Bridge*

EXAMPLE TRACK VP WITH THE TUNNEL CARD

Boise-Spokane has slots Ground, Tunnel, Tunnel. With the Tunnel card in play, laying it scores 1 + 3 + 3 = **7 VP**. With the Ground card it would score 3 + 1 + 1 = 5 VP.

REMINDER READ THE TABLE BEFORE YOU START

The three goals and the scoring card are the only cards that change from game to game in the core game. Before the first turn, read them aloud: they tell everyone which terrain to build, and whether to chase specialists, carriages, stations or a lean storage.

HISTORY PROMONTORY SUMMIT, 10 MAY 1869

The Central Pacific's Jupiter *and the Union Pacific's* No. 119 *drew up nose to nose, a ceremonial golden spike was tapped into a laurel tie, and Leland Stanford swung at the last iron spike. Travel from coast to coast fell from months to about a week.*



RARE SITUATIONS *and map regions*

These cases come up rarely. Each answers one question that players ask at the table.

REMINDER I MUST REMOVE, BUT CAN'T TAKE THE ACTION

Your worker on the centre of Lay Tracks / Move Train must be removed first, but there is no route you can lay and no move you can make. Remove it and take **no district action** this turn. Everything else in your turn still happens (with the expansion, both free-action windows too).

REMINDER I CAN'T DISPLACE ONTO LAY TRACKS

Displacing means taking that district's action. If there is no route you can lay and no move you can make, you may not displace onto Lay Tracks / Move Train.

REMINDER ALL MY WORKERS ARE OUT

If you have no worker in your supply you must remove one. Every worker space borders a Gather district or a board activation district, which can always be chosen, so a legal turn always exists.

REMINDER STORAGE OVERFLOW ON SOMEONE ELSE'S TURN

If a rival displaces your workers and the resources you take for hats overfill your storage, you discard down to your capacity at once, choosing what to discard, even though it is not your turn.

REMINDER MY TRAIN IS STUCK

A train on a city with no unlaid route cannot lay one; move it first. A train on a city that no laid route touches cannot move. If neither of your trains can do anything, you cannot choose Lay Tracks / Move Train.

REMINDER NOBODY'S STARTING CITY

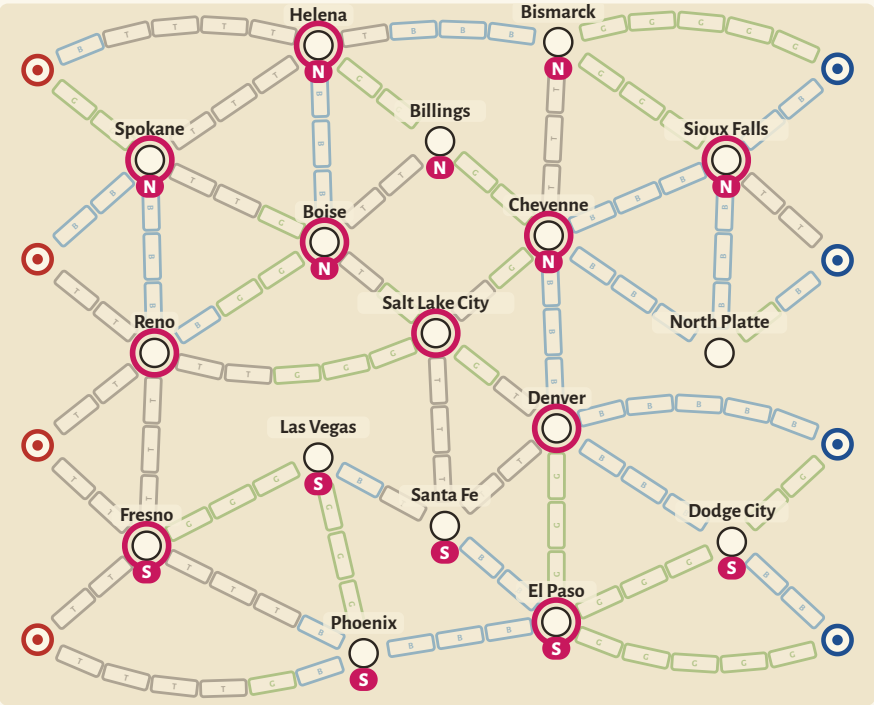
Start cities are open to everybody once the game begins: anyone may lay a route into one, pass through it or stop on it. They never hold buildings and never give a first connection.

REMINDER OUT OF HOUSES OR TELEGRAPH STATIONS

With no house left on your board you cannot place a railway station; with none left on your pole you cannot place a telegraph station. Production stops rising at 4.

Already covered elsewhere

- A hat gained this turn; a third hat: page 8.
- Specialists or upgrade tiles running out: page 3.
- No empty specialist slot: page 9.
- A Congress entry you cannot use; leftover lobby points; Reset with nothing used: page 11.
- An activation that does nothing: page 7.
- Two trains in one city: page 13.
- A second transcontinental line; ties at the end: page 16.



Regions. *A ring marks a junction city; N and S mark the North and South cities.*

CONCEPT MAP REGIONS FOR THE GOALS

- **Junction cities** (5 or more routes): Spokane, Reno, Fresno, Helena, Boise, Salt Lake City, Cheyenne, Denver, El Paso, Sioux Falls.
- **North**: Spokane, Helena, Boise, Billings, Bismarck, Cheyenne, Sioux Falls.
- **South**: Fresno, Las Vegas, Phoenix, Santa Fe, El Paso, Dodge City.
- Reno, Salt Lake City, Denver and North Platte are in neither North nor South.

GLOSSARY

Each term has exactly one meaning in this book. Page numbers show where the rule is.

- **Adjacent** (to a district): on one of its worker spaces, on its centre, or on the centre of a neighbouring district (page 8).
- **Arrival city**: the city at the far end of the route you have just laid; your train moves there (page 12).
- **Board activation**: running your player board left to right: the Foreman M times, then each upgrade tile and specialist once. Started by Ground, Tunnel and Bridge Tracks and Lobby Congress (page 10).
- **Build**: to turn resources into track tiles on your player board. Never touches the map (page 10).
- **Built tile**: a track tile in your storage. **Laid tile**: one on a route (page 2).
- **Carriage**: added to your player board; 2 specialist slots, 1 upgrade plate, 3 storage spaces; level 1, 2 or 3 in the order added (page 6).
- **Centre**: the middle of a district, used only by a displacing worker (page 8).
- **City**: a circle on the map. **Start city**: one of the 8 on the west and east edges. **Inland city**: one of the other 27 (page 12).
- **Connected city**: a city at one end of at least one laid route. All start cities count as connected from the start (page 12).
- **District**: one of the 9 areas of the action grid. Never on the map (page 7).
- **First connection**: the first route laid into an inland city: 5 VP (page 12).
- **Foreman**: the specialist printed on your engine; works M times (page 10).
- **General supply**: the shared stock of tiles, resources, Coins, specialists and carriages (page 4).
- **Goal card**: one of 3 cards scored at the end (page 17).
- **House**: a piece on your player board covering a production slot (page 6).
- **Junction city**: an inland city with 5 or more routes (page 18).
- **Lay a route**: one step of the Lay Tracks action: pay built tiles to lay a whole route. Never makes a tile (page 12).
- **Laid route**: a route with track on it. It belongs to nobody (page 12).
- **Lobby point**: what a Financier step gives; spent on Congress entries in the same activation (page 11).
- **Multiplier (M)**: 1 + your other adjacent workers + 1 for a hat (page 8).
- **Neighbours**: districts that touch along an edge, never diagonally (page 7).
- **Player board**: your own board with its carriages. Never called a train (page 6).
- **Production**: the rightmost empty house slot on a track, or 1 (page 6).
- **Railway station**: a building in a city, made from a piece taken off your house tracks; collects tolls (page 15).
- **Route**: a chain of 2 to 6 slots joining two cities; laid whole, once (page 12).
- **Scoring card**: makes one terrain worth 3 VP per slot (page 17).
- **Slot**: one space of a route: Ground, Tunnel or Bridge (page 12).
- **Start player**: seat 1, who keeps the start player marker all game (page 4).
- **Step**: one route laid or one train moved, M per Lay Tracks action (page 12).
- **Toll**: 3 VP to a railway station's owner when a rival's train enters its city (page 13).
- **Train**: one of your two pieces on the map (page 5).
- **Transcontinental line**: a chain of laid routes, laid by anyone, joining a west start city to an east start city (page 16).
- **Upgrade tile**: fitted to a carriage; works in each activation (page 14).
- **Worker space**: a pair of footprints between two neighbouring districts; holds one worker (page 7).

EXPANSION TERMS

- **Free-action window**: before your worker step and after your action (page 22).
- **Immediate / ongoing / endgame card**: the three kinds of Pony Express card (page 22).
- **Milestone**: a card claimed by the first player to meet its condition (page 20).
- **Pony Express token**: taken with a first connection; **face up** = held, **face down** = spent (page 22).

PONY EXPRESS *the expansion*

Play the core game at least once before adding the expansion.

The Pony Express expansion adds three things, always used together: **milestones**, the **Legislative Agenda**, and **Pony Express tokens and cards**. Every core rule still applies, including the three goal cards and the scoring card.

EXTRA SETUP

1. **Milestones.** Shuffle the 10 milestone cards face down and reveal 6 face up. Return the rest to the box.
2. **Legislative Agenda.** Shuffle the 17 cards and reveal 1 (page 21).
3. **Pony Express.** Put 1 token on each of the 27 inland cities; the 3 spare tokens stay in the box. Sort the cards into three decks by rank, 1, 2 and 3, shuffle each, and lay 2 cards face up from each deck: a market of 6 (page 22).

HISTORY **THE PONY EXPRESS, 1860 TO 1861**

For about eighteen months, relays of young riders carried the mail nearly 2,000 miles between St. Joseph, Missouri, and Sacramento, California, in about ten days. The service closed in October 1861, two days after the transcontinental telegraph was completed.



Milestone card back

MILESTONES

Each milestone can be claimed by **one player only**: the first to meet its condition. Claim it **the moment** you meet it, on anyone's turn: as soon as the route laid, move, building, hire, carriage or other event that met it has been resolved, before anything else happens. Score its VP at once and keep the card. One event may let you claim several milestones.

If several players meet the same milestone through the same event, the active player claims it if they are one of them; otherwise the first of them in turn order after the active player. Milestone VP scored during an activation or a Lay Tracks action change nothing else in it.

EXAMPLE **CLAIMED AT ONCE**

1. On her own turn Ivy lays two routes in one Lay Tracks action and claims **Network Complete** as the second route is laid: 7 VP.
2. Later, Ivy's trains, which started in Portland and Omaha, stand elsewhere. On Jo's turn, Jo lays Cheyenne-North Platte, completing the first chain of laid routes from Portland to Omaha. Jo scores the transcontinental bonus and triggers the end (page 16). Ivy claims **Continental Reach** at once, on Jo's turn: 7 VP.

Final scoring with the expansion adds a third line after goals: **1 VP for each face-up Pony Express token**, and your endgame Pony Express cards (cards 31 and 38, page 23).

THE TEN MILESTONE CARDS *(6 ARE REVEALED EACH GAME; THE NUMBER IN THE LAUREL IS ITS VP)*



RAIL BARON
Have 5 or more buildings on the map.



MOUNTAIN CONQUEROR
Lay a route with 3 or more Tunnel slots.



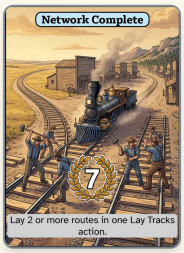
RIVER CROSSER
Lay a route with 3 or more Bridge slots.



PLAINSMAN
Lay a route with 3 or more Ground slots.



LONG HAUL
Lay a route of 5 or more slots.



NETWORK COMPLETE
Lay 2 or more routes in one Lay Tracks action.



CONTINENTAL REACH
The two cities where your trains **started** are joined by a chain of laid routes, laid by anyone.



FULL CREW
Have at least one Crew, one Miner, one Engineer and one Financier on your player board.



IRON HORSE
Have 3 carriages on your player board (the most allowed).



TELEGRAPH PIONEER
Have 4 or more telegraph stations on the map.

LEGISLATIVE AGENDA

One Legislative Agenda card is revealed at setup. It stays in force for the whole game and changes one rule **for every player equally**. The other 16 cards are not used.

When a law and a Pony Express card both add to the same event, both bonuses apply.



card back



4 Transcontinental Priority
The transcontinental bonus is 10 VP higher: 35 VP + 3 per slot.



5 Infrastructure Diversity
When the slots you laid in one Lay Tracks action include at least 2 different terrains, gain 3 VP.



6 Rapid Construction Bonus
When you laid 5 or more slots in one Lay Tracks action, gain 5 VP.



7 Station Network
When you place a building in a city that already holds another player's building, gain 5 VP.



8 Urban Development
When you place a building in a junction city (page 18), gain 2 VP.



9 Strategic Outposts
A first connection scores 8 VP instead of 5.



10 Expansion Leader
The first player to have 5 buildings on the map gains 10 VP at once. Once per game.



11 Iron Subsidy
Each Gather Iron action gives 1 extra Iron.



12 Lumber Grant
Each Gather Wood action gives 1 extra Wood.



13 Mining Incentives
Each Gather Gunpowder action gives 1 extra Gunpowder.



14 Federal Treasury
Each Gather Coins action gives 1 extra Coin.



15 Telegraph Expansion Act
When you place a telegraph station, gain 3 VP as well as its pole value.



16 Railway Network Bonus
When you place a railway station, gain 3 VP.



17 Production Scaling
When you place a railway station (taking a house from your player board), gain 2 resources of your choice.



18 Specialist Recruitment Drive
When you hire a specialist with the Hire Specialist bonus action, gain 1 resource of your choice.



19 Industrial Expansion
When you add a carriage with the Add Carriage bonus action, gain 2 resources of your choice.



20 Congressional Support
Once per board activation, right after you take a Congress entry, you may take one other available entry of the same tier without spending lobby points or Coins. Reset counts as tier 1.

REMINDER READING THE LAWS

- **One Lay Tracks action** (cards 5 and 6) means all the routes laid in one Lay Tracks / Move Train action added together, checked once when the action ends. A single route can qualify on its own.
- **The extra resource** of cards 11 to 14 is added after multiplying: Gather Iron with production 2 and M = 2 gives 2 x 2 + 1 = 5 Iron.
- Cards 18 and 19 count only the bonus actions, not hires or carriages from Congress or cards.
- There are no cards 1 to 3.

EXAMPLE STRATEGIC OUTPOSTS

With card 9 in force, Gus's first route, from Portland to Spokane (page 12), would score 6 track VP + 8 for the first connection + 1 for his telegraph station: 15 VP.

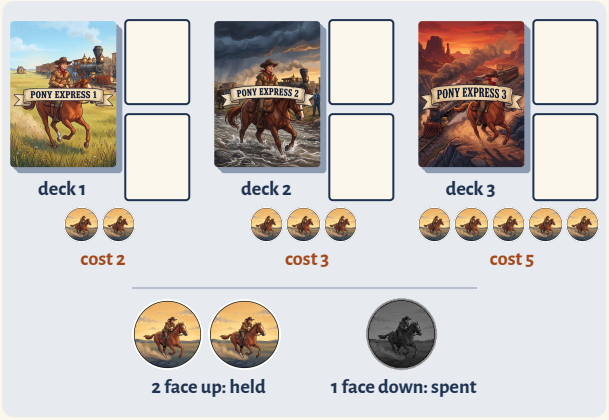
PONY EXPRESS *tokens and cards*

Collecting tokens. When a route you lay makes the **first connection** to an inland city (page 12), take that city's Pony Express token as well as the 5 VP. Keep the tokens you hold **face up** beside your board. Whenever you spend a token, turn it **face down** and keep it there: a face-down token is never used again, but Pony Express Legacy (card 38) counts it. Tokens and cards take no storage space.

Free actions. The expansion adds two **free-action windows** to your turn: one **before** your worker step and one **after** you resolve your action. In them, and only on your own turn, you may:

- **Spend a token for a resource**: turn 1 face-up token face down and take 1 resource of your choice into storage. As often as you like.
- **Buy one Pony Express card** (below). At most one per turn, in either window.
- **Use a "once per turn" card** you own (cards 14 and 28).

Free actions are never taken in the middle of an action.



YOUR TURN WITH THE EXPANSION

1. Free actions.
2. Worker step.
3. Choose the action (and hat).
4. Resolve the action.
5. Free actions.
6. End of turn.

Buying a card.

1. Choose one face-up card.
2. Pay tokens equal to its cost: **rank 1 costs 2, rank 2 costs 3, rank 3 costs 5**. Turn them face down.
3. Take the card and resolve it by its kind (below).
4. Refill the empty place from the deck of the same rank. If that deck is empty, the place stays empty.

Kinds of card.

- **Immediate**: resolve the whole effect now, then discard the card. You cannot buy one of which no part can be carried out.
- **Ongoing**: keep it face up in front of you. It works for you for the rest of the game, starting now. **You may hold at most 2 ongoing cards**; with 2 you cannot buy another.
- **Endgame**: keep it face up. It scores in final scoring and does not count towards the limit of 2.

"Once per turn" cards may be used once in each of your turns, in either window, including the turn you buy them. A hat from a card bought this turn cannot be spent this turn (page 8).

End of game. Each **face-up** token scores 1 VP. Pony Express Legacy counts all your tokens, face up and face down.

RANK 1 CARDS *cost 2 tokens, all immediate*



1 FRESH HORSES
Gain 3 resources of your choice.



2 SADDLE BAGS
Add 1 carriage for free.



3 SWIFT PASSAGE
Take up to 2 Move Train steps now.



4 FRONTIER SCOUT
Gain 2 built track tiles of two different types.



5 QUICK ROUTE
Lay 1 route now (one step). It counts as a Lay Tracks action of its own.



6 FRONTIER RECRUITMENT
Hire 1 specialist for free.



7 MAIL DELIVERY CONTRACT
Gain 5 VP.



8 VERSATILE RIDER
Choose one: 2 built track tiles of your choice, or 3 resources of your choice, or 1 cowboy hat.



9 RAPID EXPANSION
Add 1 carriage for free, and hire 1 specialist without paying the 1 Coin. In either order; you may skip either part.



10 DOUBLE TIME
Activate your player board now with M = 1. Choose the Foreman's type first.



11 FRONTIER TRADE
Return up to 3 resources from your storage and gain the same number of resources of your choice.



12 FRONTIER LEGEND
Gain 1 VP for each inland city that holds at least one of your buildings.



13 CONGRESSIONAL COURIER
Take up to 2 available tier 1 Congress entries (entry 1, entry 2, Reset) without lobby points or Coins.

PONY EXPRESS CARDS *ranks 2 and 3*

RANK 2 CARDS *cost 3 tokens*



14 OVERLAND ROUTE *ongoing*
Once per turn, in a free-action window, you may take 1 Move Train step.



15 PIONEER'S KNOWLEDGE *ongoing*
At the start of each of your board activations, choose one specialist on your player board (not the Foreman): it works 1 extra time in this activation.



16 EXPRESS MAIL CONTRACT *ongoing*
When you place a telegraph station, gain 2 resources of your choice.



17 FRONTIER EXPANSION *immediate*
Add up to 2 carriages for free, without going over 3.



18 BULK SHIPMENT *immediate*
Gain 5 resources of your choice.



19 TRACK STOCKPILE *immediate*
Gain 3 built track tiles of your choice.



20 CONGRESSIONAL FAVOR *ongoing*
The first Congress entry you take in each board activation costs 1 Coin less (not below 0).



21 EFFICIENT OPERATIONS *ongoing*
Each of your Gather actions gives 1 extra of what you gathered, added after multiplying.



22 DOUBLE TIME *immediate*
As card 10.



23 VERSATILE RIDER *immediate*
As card 8.



24 CONGRESSIONAL COURIER *immediate*
As card 13.



Rank 1: 2 tokens



Rank 2: 3 tokens



Rank 3: 5 tokens

RANK 3 CARDS *cost 5 tokens*



25 TRANSCONTINENTAL EXPRESS *ongoing*
If you lay the route that completes the first transcontinental line, gain 10 extra VP.



26 MASTER NETWORK *ongoing*
Tolls paid to you are 5 VP instead of 3.



27 EXPERIENCED CREW *immediate*
Hire up to 2 specialists for free.



28 FRONTIER MASTERY *ongoing*
Once per turn, in a free-action window, you may take any one of the four bonus actions without being at its district and without paying its printed cost.



29 RAILS AND RIDERS *ongoing*
Your first connections score 3 extra VP.



30 POLITICAL INFLUENCE *ongoing*
When you take Reset, gain 2 VP per senator returned instead of 1.



31 TERRITORY BARON *endgame*
5 VP for each city in which you own both the railway station and the telegraph station.



32 MASTER ENGINEER *ongoing*
Each time your Foreman works, you choose which of the four specialist types he acts as.



33 SPECIALIST MASTERY *immediate*
Choose a specialist type. Until the end of this turn, each of your specialists of that type works twice in each board activation instead of once. The Foreman is not affected.



34 TELEGRAPH TYCOON *ongoing*
The pole VP you score when you place a telegraph station are doubled.



35 TRACK MASTER *ongoing*
When a route you lay makes a first connection, every slot of that route scores 3 VP more.



36 PRODUCTION MASTERY *ongoing*
Your production is 1 higher on all four tracks.



37 CONGRESSIONAL CONTROL *ongoing*
Tier 1 Congress entries (entry 1, entry 2, Reset) cost you no Coins. They still cost 1 lobby point.



38 PONY EXPRESS LEGACY *endgame*
3 VP for each Pony Express token you collected during the game, face up or face down.

REMINDER CARD TIMING

- Ongoing cards help only their owner, from the moment they are bought.
- **Production Mastery** raises production itself, so it is multiplied: production 2 becomes 3, and with M = 2 you gather 6. **Efficient Operations** and the laws on page 21 add after multiplying.
- **Track Master** adds to the scoring card: a slot of the scoring card's terrain scores 3 + 3 = 6.
- **Specialist Mastery** helps only if you buy it in your first free-action window of a turn in which you then activate your player board. With **Pioneer's Knowledge** on the same specialist, double first, then add: it works 2 + 1 = 3 times.
- **Double Time** and **Quick Route** happen in a free-action window, outside your worker action; Quick Route's route still follows every rule on page 12.
- A bonus action from Frontier Mastery is extra to the one you may take at a Gather district.

QUICK REFERENCE *at the table*



The action grid. *Nine districts; the four Gather districts print the bonus actions.*

Your turn

(with the expansion: free actions before the worker step and after resolving)

1. **Worker step**: Place on an empty worker space, Remove one of your workers (a centre worker first), or Displace onto a surrounded district's centre. Displace: each worker sent home gives its owner 1 hat (or 1 resource at 2 hats).
2. **Choose** one district the worker gives you; you may spend 1 hat held since your turn began.
3. **Resolve** with **M = 1 + your other adjacent workers + 1 for a hat**.
4. **End of turn**: check the game end.

The districts

District	Action	Bonus action
Gather Iron / Wood / Gunpowder / Coins	Gain production x M	Iron: Hire Specialist (1 Coin). Wood: Buy Hat (1 Gunpowder). Gunpowder: Carriage Upgrade (1 Iron). Coins: Add Carriage (1 Wood).
Ground / Tunnel / Bridge Tracks	Board activation; Foreman is a Crew / Miner / Engineer	-
Lobby Congress	Board activation; Foreman is a Financier	-
Lay Tracks / Move Train	M steps: each lays one route or moves one train	-

Board activation

Foreman M times; then each carriage in level order: upgrade tile once, left specialist once, right specialist once.

Crew to **Ground**
Miner to **Tunnel**
Engineer to **Bridge**
Financier to **1 lobby point**

Build ≠ Lay

Building fills your storage; only Lay Tracks puts tiles on the map.

Congress

Tier = lobby points = Coins. 1: 3 Wood. 2: 3 Iron. 3: 4 Gunpowder + 1 hat. 4: a carriage + a free hire. 5: 3 built tiles. 6: 6 resources of your choice. Reset (1 + 1): senators back, 1 VP each.

Lay a route

Unlaid route, your train at one end, matching built tiles. Pay → track VP → advance → first connection → toll → transcontinental check → free building (inland city with room).

Move

One train, any path of laid routes entering no city twice; 3 VP to each rival railway station entered; then 2 Coins for a building.

Storage

6 + 3 per carriage (9 to 15). Discard overflow at once. **HATS**: at most 2; a third becomes a resource.

Scoring during play

- Track: 1 VP per slot; 3 VP per slot of the scoring card's terrain
- First connection to an inland city: 5 VP (expansion: and its token)
- Telegraph station: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 9
- Toll: 3 VP to the station owner
- Reset: 1 VP per senator
- Upgrade tiles; milestones (expansion)
- Laying the route that completes the first transcontinental line: 25 VP + 3 per slot of that route

Game end

First transcontinental line (any laid routes), or laid routes ≥ 8 per player at the end of a turn. Play on until the player on the start player's right has had their turn, so everyone has had the same number of turns.

Final scoring

Buildings (1: 2, 2: 4, 3: 7, 4: 10, 5: 14, 6: 18, 7: 23, 8: 28, 9: 34, 10: 40, 11: 47, 12: 54, 13: 62, 14: 70, 15: 79, 16: 88, 17: 98, 18: 108); goals 10 / 5 (2 players: first only); expansion: 1 VP per face-up token, endgame cards.

Ties

Most buildings, most stored items, closest to the start player.